

096. Chapter 7 Verses 20-23

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 7.20

कामैस्तैस्तैर्हृतज्ञानाः प्रपद्यन्तेऽन्यदेवताः ।
तं तं नियममास्थाय प्रकृत्या नियताः स्वया ॥ 20 ॥

kāmaistaistairhṛtajñānāḥ
prapadyante'nyadevatāḥ |
taṁ taṁ niyamamāsthāya
prakṛtyā niyatāḥ svayā ||

- ◆ **kāmaiḥ** – by desires; **taiḥ taiḥ** – by various; **hṛta-jñānāḥ** – whose wisdom is led away;
- ◆ **prapadyante** – surrender/resort to; **anya-devatāḥ** – other gods/deities;
- ◆ **taṁ taṁ** – that and that; **niyamam** – rule/rite; **āsthāya** – following;
- ◆ **prakṛtyā** – by nature; **niyatāḥ** – led/governed; **svayā** – by their own.

But those whose discrimination has been led astray by various desires resort to other deities, following diverse rituals, constrained by their own natures.

VERSE 7.21

yo yo yāṃ yāṃ tanuṃ bhaktaḥ
śraddhayārcitumicchati ।
tasya tasyācalāṃ śraddhāṃ
tāmeva vidadhāmyaham ॥

- ◆ yaḥ yaḥ – whoever; yāṃ yāṃ – whichever; tanuṃ – form/deity; bhaktaḥ – devotee;
- ◆ śraddhayā – with faith; arcitum – to worship; icchati – desires;
- ◆ tasya tasya – of him; acalāṃ – unflinching; śraddhāṃ – faith;
- ◆ tāṃ eva – that very; vidadhāmi – bestow/ordain; aham – I.

Whatever may be the form a devotee seeks to worship with faith— in that form alone I make his faith unwavering.

VERSE 7.22

स तया श्रद्धया युक्तस्तस्याराधनमीहते ।
लभते च ततः कामान्मयैव विहितान्हि तान् ॥ 22 ॥

sa tayā śraddhayā yuktas
tasyārādhanamīhate |
labhate ca tataḥ kāmān
mayaiva vihitānhi tān ||

- ◆ **saḥ** – he; **tayā** – with that; **śraddhayā** – faith; **yuktaḥ** – endowed;
- ◆ **tasya** – of that (deity); **ārādhanam** – worship; **īhate** – performs;
- ◆ **labhate** – obtains; **ca** – and; **tataḥ** – from that; **kāmān** – desires;
- ◆ **mayā eva** – by Me alone; **vihitān** – ordained; **hi** – indeed; **tān** – those.

Possessed of that faith, he worships that form and from it attains his desires, which are, in reality, granted by Me alone.

VERSE 7.23

अन्तवत्तु फलं तेषां तद्भवत्यल्पमेधसाम् ।
देवान्देवयजो यान्ति मद्भक्ता यान्ति मामपि ॥ 23 ॥

antavattu phalaṃ teṣāṃ
tadbhavatyalpamedhasām |
devāndevayajo yānti
madbhaktā yānti māmapi ||

- ◆ **antavat** – finite/perishable; **tu** – but; **phalam** – fruit; **teṣām** – of them;
- ◆ **tat** – that; **bhavati** – is; **alpa-medhasām** – of those of small intelligence;
- ◆ **devān** – to the gods; **deva-yajaḥ** – the worshippers of gods; **yānti** – go;
- ◆ **mat-bhaktāḥ** – My devotees; **yānti** – go; **mām api** – to Me also.

**But finite is the result gained by these men of small minds.
Those who worship the deities go to the deities; those who
worship Me come to Me.**